

Rituximab: Riabni, Rituxan, Rituxan Hycela, Ruxience, Truxima

Effective Date: 11/10/2024

Revision Date(s): 11/14/2023, 4/17/2024, 9/9/2024, **1/17/2025**

Review Date: 9/9/2024

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All GEHA Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Preferred	Yes	Ruxience	Q5119	Injection, rituximab-pvvr, biosimilar, (Ruxience), 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Truxima	Q5115	Injection, rituximab-abbs, biosimilar, (Truxima), 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Rituxan Hycela	J9311	Injection, rituximab 10 mg and hyaluronidase
Non-Preferred	Yes	Rituxan	J9312	Injection, rituximab, 10 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	Riabni	Q5123	Injection, rituximab-arrr, biosimilar, (Riabni), 10 mg

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents prior to approval of a non-preferred product.
- Preferred product requirements apply to new starts ONLY.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with all components of the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**

- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
 - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association; Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;
 - **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Rituxan Hycela	J9311	Injection, rituximab 10 mg and hyaluronidase
Rituxan	J9312	Injection, rituximab, 10 mg
Truxima	Q5115	Injection, rituximab-abbs, biosimilar, (Truxima), 10 mg
Ruxience	Q5119	Injection, rituximab-pvvr, biosimilar, (Ruxience), 10 mg
Riabni	Q5123	Injection, rituximab-arxx, biosimilar, (Riabni), 10 mg

References

1. Riabni [package insert]. Amgen Inc., Thousand Oaks, CA. Available at: https://www.pi.amgen.com/~media/amgen/repositorysites/pi-amgen-com/riabni/riabni_pi_english.ashx
2. Riabni. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content
3. Rituxan [package insert]. Genentech, Inc., South San Francisco, CA. Available at: https://www.gene.com/download/pdf/rituxan_prescribing.pdf
4. Rituxan. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content
5. Rituxan Hycela [package insert]. Genentech, Inc., South San Francisco, CA. Available at: https://www.gene.com/download/pdf/rituxan_hycela_prescribing.pdf

6. Rituxan Hyclea. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content
7. Ruxience [package insert]. Pfizer Biosimilars. New York, NY. Available at: <https://labeling.pfizer.com/ShowLabeling.aspx?id=12090>
8. Ruxience. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content
9. Truxima [package insert]. Teva Pharmaceuticals USA, Inc., North Wales, PA. Available at: <https://www.truxima.com/globalassets/truxima-dtc/pdfs/truxima-prescribing-information.pdf>
10. Truxima. NCCN Drugs & Biologics Compendium. Available at https://www.nccn.org/professionals/drug_compendium/content
11. Referenced with permission from the NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®). National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2023. All rights reserved. Accessed September 9th, 2024. To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NCCN.org.

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Date	Updates
4/1/23	Policy Inception
11/14/2023	Updated Step Therapy to Table, Added Universal Criteria, Updated References, Updated footer
4/17/2024	Updated Universal Criteria
9/9/2024	Annual Review – Update to Universal Criteria
1/17/2025	Document format updated to be universally accessible